

Town of Hampton



September 14, 2026

Present: Carleigh Beriont, Chair
Jeffrey Grip, Vice-chair
Amy Hansen
Donald Bliss
Charles Rage
James Sullivan, Town Manager

Chair Beriont opened the meeting at 7:00 p.m. [-1:22]

SALUTE TO THE FLAG

- I. Public Comment [Time limitation of three (3) minutes] [-1:22]
- II. Announcements and Community Calendar [-1:21]

Sel. Grip: Congratulations to the Moderator and Town Clerk and their workers for an exceptionally well-run election on Tuesday, hopefully, it will be the same for November.

Sel. Rage: Ditto on those remarks; I want to thank all the volunteers at the Seafood Festival; it went great, and if Sunday's weather was better, it could have been in the top ten.

Sel. Hansen: The election went very well, I appreciate all the voters who came out to utilize their right to vote; the American Legion Post 35's 911 ceremony was very moving, it was the 25th anniversary of that day.

Chair Beriont: Thank you to the Moderator, the Town Clerk, the Supervisors of the Checklist, and to all of the volunteers and workers and voters for such a successful election day. Thank you to Berk Bennett and the American Legion Post 35 for the very meaningful and moving ceremony to mark the 25th anniversary of September 11th. On Wednesday the 16th, Hobbs House will host the Building Bridges free luncheon for veterans. Fall Fridays are back at the Gazebo in Depot Square. The Household Hazardous Waste collection is on September 19th at the Transfer Station from 8 a.m. to 12 p.m.

- III. Approval of Minutes [-1:19]

1. August 24, 2026

Sel. Hansen: Page 1, under Announcements, the Longest Table add Rotary after Hampton.

Sel. Grip: Page 5, second line, replace "adding requirements to properties on the west side of Lafayette Road" with "adding requirements to properties in the Town center district or within one half mile of the Greenway".

Sel. Bliss MOTIONED to ADOPT the minutes of August 24, 2026 as amended, SECONDED by Sel. Rage. Vote 5-0-0.

IV. Consent Agenda [-1:18]

1. Cemetery Deed: Morrill Family Rev Living Trust I-7/16/2/1&3
2. Donation: Tri-Rent-All for Police Comfort Dog "Gus" \$500, and K-9 \$500, Senior Programs Anonymous \$250
3. One-day Entertainment License: Rotary Club "Fall Fridays" Gazebo 09/25-10/23,
4. Naming of Street: "Knowles Circle" 24 Locke Road Subdivision
5. Pool Table Permit: Water's Edge Yacht Club
6. Raffle Permit: Hampton Academy 8th Grade Nov. 16th - Dec. 17th
7. Use of Town Property: Rotary Club "Fall Fridays" Gazebo 09/25-10/23, Trinity Episcopal "Peace Vigil" Gazebo 09/21; First Congregational Church, United Methodist, Trinity Episcopal and N. Hampton UCC "Ecumenical Blessing of the Animals" 10/03/26; Brillard "Wedding" Bicentennial Park North 08/21/27

Sel. Grip MOTIONED to MOVE the Consent Agenda, SECONDED by Sel. Hansen. Vote 5-0-0.

V. Appointments [-1:15]

1. Rene Boudreau, Parks & Recreation Director
 - a Quarterly Report

Dir. Boudreau: Summer is the busiest. Summer camp, seven weeks, Monday through Friday, 40 hours a week, two field trips a week, six very energetic staff worked really hard for seven weeks keeping the kids of Hampton happy and safe; also had many sports camps, Lego camps, tennis camps, and science programs throughout the summer; Tuck Field has a new pavilion down near the pickleball and tennis courts. The new bus and truck have arrived. Collette Travel trips: pre-meeting for the closed Greece trip is Wednesday; the Hawaiian trip in March 2027. Trick or Treat is scheduled for October 31st from 5:30 p.m. to 8:00 p.m., Toddler Trick or Treat on October 29th with the library, at 4:00 p.m. Planning for the Tree Lighting.

Dir. Boudreau: Requests that the old bus and truck be surplus, to be sold. Sel. Hansen: Is there any interest in keeping the truck as a staff vehicle? Dir. Boudreau: Unfortunately, no.

Sel. Rage MOTIONED to DECLARE the old Recreation Bus and Truck as surplus property and AUTHORIZE both to be sold in the best interest of the community, SECONDED by Sel. Hansen. Vote 5-0-0.

Discussion: Clarification on year-to-date net revenue of \$227,802, in just the past sixty days \$51,000; the impact of the decrease in parking revenue will have on Parks and Recreation budgeting; the decrease will impact the percentage that goes into that fund, revenues are running \$200,000 below.

VI. Town Manager's Report [-45.40]

TM Sullivan: Seafood Festival went well, no significant issues reported. Received the renewal from Primex, the Risk Pool Insurer; there is an approximate 35% increase for Property & Liability, Received a refund for Workers Comp, the net impact between the two for the budget is \$89,000 above what was budgeted; primary reason was that we were in a capped program, which for three years kept the increases between 7 and 10%; Primex is not offering the program again. BTLA Order for the First Report was submitted on September 1st, we are working on finalizing a contract that meets all of DRA standards and requirements with the RFP vendor.

Budget development is underway and are on track to have the budget before the Board in October.

Discussion. The town has done competitive bidding for the insurance in previous years; the issue for us is that the Risk Pool gives the town coverage on the pump stations down at the beach; we could not get covered for the pump stations from a private insurer if there were to be a significant flooding event. Sel. Bliss: Given my experience with Primex, I do not believe we would get any better rates or better value than being in that risk pool, particularly given the amount of training and other support that Primex provides that is specifically geared to New Hampshire municipalities.

1. NH DOT Bridge Lighting Update

Chair Beriont: on Friday, September 11th, we had a meeting with Executive Councilor Janet Stevens, DOT Commissioner David Rodrigue, Select Board member Amy Hansen, Alex Loiseau from the Hampton Beach Area Commission and Town Manager Sullivan. Everyone agreed that lighting should be added to the bridge for security; the Board now needs to decide whether to request pedestrian-only lighting or both pedestrian and roadway lights, we need to send a letter to DOT as soon as possible indicating our preference; we need to decide what kind of lights, and then DOT will give us options.

The Board engaged in a lengthy discussion regarding the lighting for the bridge. Key points were: DOT will cover the cost of installing lights on the bridge, ongoing maintenance and operation costs will need to be decided later, falling to either the state or the town; pros and cons of each lighting type were discussed; installation will take at least a year; maintenance is a major issue: the town does not have the equipment or staff to service lights; federal funds can pay for installation but not long-term upkeep; the state has not shown interest in maintaining the lights; members agree pedestrian lighting is essential for safety due to the bridge's height and windy conditions, members prefer full roadway and pedestrian lighting for maximum security; DOT requires a formal request specifying which type the town wants.

Sel. Hansen MOTIONED to direct the Town Manager to write a letter to the Commissioner of DOT requesting the maximum safety for lighting, both pedestrian and roadway, to express the Board's interest in those options and return presentation to us with cost and maintenance, SECONDED by Sel. Grip. Vote 5-0-0.

VII. Committee Reports [-50.30]

Chair Beriont: Budget Committee will meet tomorrow night.

Sel. Hansen: Hampton Beach Village District. Season is wrapping up; the LED Show is this Friday, Saturday is the Fire Show and fireworks on New Years Eve.

Sel. Grip: Planning Board. Ben Ritt, Coastal Resilience Coordinator spoke about the resilience roadmap, a proposed compensatory flood storage zoning article; Brianna Hagen, Conservation Coordinator spoke about two proposed zoning articles, what defines an open deck and extending the time limit for wetlands permits; Jason Bachand, Town Planner spoke about zoning articles defining frontage on corner lots and combining the business, beach seasonal and business seasonal into one zone. Thomas Jones and William McEvoy were appointed Board alternates.

Sel. Bliss: 79-E Advisory Committee is starting to wrap up its work, preparing the presentation to this Board, tentatively on September 28th. Heritage Commission is exploring the feasibility of applying for an LCHIP grant for the Blacksmith Shop.

VIII. Old Business [-45.52]

1. Draft Commercial Refuse Collection Policy

Chair Beriont: before the Board is a history of warrant articles regarding solid waste going back to 1963 and the draft policy for solid waste which has taken into account the feedback and suggestions that were made at the last meeting. To clarify, it has not been voted on, nor has there been a public hearing scheduled for it.

TM Sullivan: It was a more complicated task than anticipated; the team worked on consolidating several solid waste policies, but since Chapter 420 can only be changed by Town Meeting vote, it was kept separate; this document combines the Cart Policy, Chapter 761, and the commercial cost-recovery program into a single updated document. DPW staff helped identify conflicts and adjustments were made; the draft shows the changes. If the Board feels this meets the goal, staff will finalize the document, address remaining issues, and make it available for public review before the public hearing.

The Board engaged in discussion on the draft. Key points were defining the word parcel, and commercial; curbside collection will be tied to the parcel; not to suspend trash pick-up if businesses are in arrears, placing a lien instead; health and safety take priority; a town meeting vote would be needed to change Chapter 420; the history of warrant articles showed robust discussion on the subjects of the transfer station and pay per bag; curbside collection of commercial trash was not addressed in the warrant article history; direct conflicts with Chapter 420 were removed. Whether or not this goes into effect by vote of the Select Board or Town Meeting vote, need to leave open the possibility of amending and revising based on how it will be implemented, every major change will have unanticipated consequences despite trying to think about all the possibilities. Finance has reviewed the analysis of Caroline Gagan, there are some assumptions she uses that we disagree with, Finance is confident in their numbers based on talking to the people who do the work for what is needed for collection. Question as to whether the Board will be doing this or not. The public hearing should not be at a regular Board meeting.

The Board would like to see the policy with the revisions that considers Sel. Hansen's concerns with nonpayment and the other suggested revisions; have that revised policy at the Board's next meeting, at which time the Board will be in the position to set a date for a public hearing.

2. Primex Goal Setting Report Suggestions Implementation

Chair Beriont: Highlighted Hampton's current strengths, first responders, the Transfer Station, a culture of teamwork, elected officials support of employees, partnerships with nonprofits, coastal resilience work, strong department heads, grant funding, financial transparency efforts, award-winning master plan, housing accreditation. Identified the areas that challenges the town: combating misinformation, staff recruitment, road maintenance and replacement, reduction in federal/state aid, perceptions of having high property taxes, operating under a default budget, changes in demographics, technology and cybersecurity demands, beach-community relations, the High Street/Route 1 interchange, communicating the value of town services, space requirements, the need for a new DPW facility, natural disaster impacts, lights

on the new bridge, and sewer for the west side of town. The Board has established five main goals: Infrastructure, Planning, Staffing & Recruitment, Budget, DPW Staffing & Strategy.

The Board engaged in a discussion on implementing the goals outlined in the report. The Board expressed general agreement with the goals, discussion on what the Board does next, and how best to implement them, whether through subgroups, placing each goal on subsequent agendas. TM Sullivan recommended that the Board accept this, so the goals can be communicated to Department Heads so they can incorporate them into their budgets and objectives, simple goals are already met. Prioritization by departments with what is most important. The Board discussed that this is an interactive process, coordinate with the Master Plan Implementation Committee. The report will be shared with the Budget Committee.

Sel. Rage MOTIONED to ACCEPT and implement the goals therein established SECONDED by Sel. Bliss. Vote 5-0-0.

IX. New Business [-07.03]

1. BTLA Order First Report – discussed under Town Manager’s report.

Sel. Grip: I would request that on the town’s webpage have a list of projects in progress, the completion dates for them, and their next steps.

Board discussed what type of projects would be listed; most information is already up on the website, but by departments; centralizing the information in one place; ability to make the search for information easier; using AI to accomplish that.

Chair Beriont requested a motion to enter into nonpublic session under RSA 91-A:3,II(l)

At 8:22 p.m. Sel. Bliss MOTIONED to enter into a Nonpublic Session under RSA 91-A:3,II(l) consideration of Legal Advice in writing or oral, SECONDED by Sel. Rage. Vote 5-0-0.

Public Session Minutes prepared by K. Ostman

Present: Carleigh Beriont, Chair
Jeffrey Grip, Vice-chair
Amy Hansen
Donald Bliss
Charles Rage
James Sullivan, Town Manager

The Board returned to Public Session at 8:26 p.m.

Sel. Hansen MOTIONED to seal the minutes because it was determined that divulgence of the information likely would render a proposed action ineffective, SECONDED by Sel. Rage. Vote 5-0-0.

Minutes Sealed

Sel. Hansen MOTIONED to adjourn the Public Session at 8:28 p.m., SECONDED by Sel. Rage. Vote 5-0-0.

Carleigh Beriont, Chair

Nonpublic Minutes prepared by James Sullivan, Town Manager